

"Vodafone will join national and multi-national carriers in decisions that influence the development of Ubuntu for smartphones," sources at Canonical said in an official statement. This means that Vodafone will soon make sure users all across its global network have access to Ubuntu-powered mobile devices. Ubuntu Carrier Advisor Group also includes China Unicom, Deutsche Telekom, Everything Everywhere, SK Telecom, Telecom Italia, Telstra, T-Mobile and Verizon Wireless.

LibreOffice 4.2 released

The Document Foundation has now come out with the latest version of LibreOffice, the popular open source office suite. LibreOffice 4.2 comes with a set of new and improved features for power and enterprise users. It will be shipped as part of Ubuntu 14.04 LTS later this year.

"LibreOffice 4.2 features a large number of performance and interoperability improvements targeted at users of all kinds, but particularly appealing for power and enterprise users," the developers claim. The update has gone through what is supposedly the 'largest' code refactoring ever, claims the Foundation. This gives it a major performance boost for big data. An optional new formula interpreter enables massively parallel calculation of formula cells using the GPU via OpenCL that works best with a Heterogeneous System Architecture (HSA). The update includes improved integration with Windows.

LibreOffice 4.2 offers round-trip interoperability with Microsoft OOXML (particularly for DOCX and legacy RTF). It comes with a simplified custom install dialogue box to avoid potential mistakes. Users can now centrally manage and lock-down the configuration with Group Policy Objects via Active Directory. It also comes with a new Start screen, and a much cleaner layout.



US high school gives away 1,725 Linux-powered laptops to students!

The Penn Manor High School in the US has doled out as many as 1,725 Linux-powered laptops to its students. The school has provided every student, from grades 9-12, an Acer TravelMate laptop preloaded with Ubuntu 13.10. Following a roughly 5-minute orientation, students were then let loose to use their creativity on the devices. "We encourage our students to install software and lift the hood of the system to better understand what makes it tick. I hope our students run local Web servers, toy with Python or simply explore graphics programs such as the GIMP. Linux offers so many opportunities to explore computing, programming and the arts," the school's technology director, Charlie Reisinger, was quoted as saying.

"Linux allows a level of exploration and control that other closed devices don't. The cost savings in switching to all open source software is an added benefit," Reisinger added.

OpenDaylight's first open source, software-defined network release is out

In an attempt to tackle one of IT's toughest challenges, which is simplifying network management, OpenDaylight (an open source, software-defined networking platform) is finally out with its 'first' release. The first release of the program, Hydrogen, "...is a great step forward and the community is already looking to build

CyanogenMod 11.0 M3 debuts for over 50 devices

The CyanogenMod team has announced the release of CM 11.0 M Snapshot builds based on Android 4.4 KitKat for as many as 50 devices and variants. The new builds come with a slew of new additions, the most prominent being the revamped Trebuchet launcher, which is now based on KitKat launcher.

"M3 includes the return of Trebuchet, now based on KitKat's Launcher3 code base, and has been completely rewritten by its maintainer Nebojša Cvetkovi (nebkat). Additional work has been included to provide universal icon pack support by Danesh M (devatwork)," said the CM team in a blog post. Another major addition is the Privacy Guard, which can be used to control an app from auto-starting. Further, for users updating from 10.2 or a previous 11-M build, the new version of Trebuchet will preserve your home screen data if you were previously using Launcher3 or Trebuchet. Meanwhile, the upcoming release of CM 11.0 will have left-handed navigation bar support, additional transparency in the SystemUI, icon mask support in the launcher, better themes integration, and Google Now-like experiences in Trebuchet.

Here are some of the more popular devices getting the CM 11.0 M3 build:



- Samsung Galaxy S4 and variants
- Nexus devices
- Samsung Galaxy S, S II, S III and their variants
- LG Optimus G, G2 and G Pro
- HTC One, Droid DNA, One X, One X+ and One S
- Nook Color